

Radical Choices and Emotional Literacy

Individuals all have an inherent emotional intelligence (EQ). Emotional Literacy is the ability and commitment to be self-aware, and, as a result, to make decisions and behave in alignment with an individual's objectives and vision. People who achieve this ability can accomplish business and personal relationship goals with ease and unimagined success. Radical Choices teaches people to apply this skill to their everyday decisions and behaviors through our emotional literacy learning process.

Studies now substantiate that an individual's success is more dependent upon "Emotional IQ" than intellectual intelligence. Emotional literacy is a transferable skill. Radical Choices has developed a learning technology that facilitates the learning of emotional literacy. Training programs designed and delivered within the context of emotional literacy provide deeper, longer-term learning and facilitate real behavior change.

What Is Emotional Literacy?

Throughout our lives, there are many events that we want to leave behind, so we often cloud them up or create pleasant illusions to cover up the pain. When we do this we then forget in our conscious minds what happened. However, when experiences are interpreted and changed and the feelings are diluted and dulled, the experience doesn't go away. They build up power and begin to control our behavior, albeit unconsciously.

We develop our patterns of clouding over painful emotions, patterns of interpretation and protection, in our childhood. Because of this, many of us have no idea what and when we're feeling. We are really reacting to a situation according to the patterns we developed as children. We "act out." Acting out is when we feel something like sadness or anger or happiness and either don't realize it, don't understand why, or won't allow ourselves to experience the feelings all the way. Instead they explode or leak out in other

ways. For instance, a child who is jealous of a new sibling is not usually allowed to feel that--instead they may stab the baby with crayons. Similarly, feelings of jealousy on the job may not be experienced, but acted out through backbiting or sabotage.

Emotional literacy is the ability to be self aware, to understand what we are feeling and finally to choose our behavior. With this self-awareness, we can behave in ways that produce specific, desired results in the workplace. Radical Choices methodologies specifically teach emotional literacy tools that help people to become conscious of their own experiences, feelings, and resistance to change so that they are not compelled to continue old behavioral patterns that unconsciously sabotage their relationships with managers, employees, customers, friends or family. It includes developing the skills to recognize the unspoken messages from others, so that individuals can align themselves and address real needs and issues. The direct results include the development of authentic, healthy relationships based upon trust and relevant information. These results can translate into motivated, empowered employees and loyal customers.

Radical Choices and Business Results

A disadvantage of not feeling everything is that we misinterpret what is going on. This is deadly in our relationships and our businesses. Someone we are dealing with may feel angry, and if we are not able to experience anger we may think he or she are sad or not notice, and then act on that faulty information. This kind of misinterpreting seriously damages business and personal relationships.

Knowing the emotional underpinning of the decisions that we make and the emotional content of interactions with our co-workers and clients can provide a new dimension of comprehension to almost every situation in the workplace. Radical Choices has over 30 years of teaching the technology of emotional literacy and its applications at work.

- Emotional Literacy includes developing the skills to recognize the unspoken messages from others, so that individuals can align themselves and address real needs and issues.



For example, a client's words may be about the cost being too much, but the real issue may be a lack of trust. Or, an associate may be acting angry but underneath, they are really just having a hard time with change.

> An Emotionally Literate person doesn't read something into an interaction or situation. An Emotionally Literate person knows what is truly going on. He or she won't respond to something happening now with a response from their history.

For example, if a manager behaves in a way that seems to be similar to a disrespectful manager from the past, they just notice that as information-but doesn't act on whatever feelings that resemblance engenders.

> Emotional Literacy teaches people to become conscious of their own experiences, feelings, and resistance to change, so that they can change old behavioral patterns rather than be compelled to continue them.

For example. If a firm is undergoing significant change, an emotionally literate person understands that cognitive dissonance (the discomfort caused when old beliefs are confronted with current reality) is part of the process of adapting to change and growing. Knowing this, a person is able to choose short-term discomfort for long-term behavioral change.

> An emotionally literate person is able to create Trusted Advisor relationships by listening to a clients' deepest needs and desires and respond in an authentic manner.

By applying this technology to our own organization and our clients, we have gained an understanding of how the brain works in relationship to emotions and behavior. This understanding led to the knowledge that people need not be controlled by emotional impulses, either conscience or unconscious, and that it is possible to make real choices about behaviors when there is a conscious awareness of emotions. Radical Choices has demonstrated to some of the

world's largest companies that when the principles of emotional literacy are applied, they are like gravity-they work whether we believe in it or not.

Radical Choices has developed Emotional Literacy Technology through over 20 years of work with individuals and organizations observing, studying, and mapping the underlying nature of people and their behavior. This research and understanding led to the development of tools and learning systems where people discover that they need not be controlled by emotional impulses, either conscious or unconscious. Radical Choices learned to simulate real-world environments and use cognitive dissonance to give people the opportunity to risk new behaviors, make mistakes and learns new skills and changes their mindsets. Radical Choices has become expert at helping people transform their lives.

simultaneously. Our resistance is just pure energy that we use to transform history into awareness. We are no longer bound to continue behavior patterns that impair and degrade our relationships. When we have shaped and formed the muscle of self-awareness, we are able to change our conditioned wiring at the same time we are in reaction. Really!!! It is then and only then we have free choice and can choose a different trajectory right in the fire of reaction. The either/or disappears and an open field of possibilities appear.

We are all in the same tribe.

Real Impact learning and Emotional Literacy

Individuals all have a native emotional knowledge of the world. As children, we are usually aware our feelings. We are taught by our family which of these feelings are safe to share and which we need to put to the side. Because of this, we learn how to adapt to the world around us as needed.

(EL). Emotional Literacy is the ability and commitment to be self-aware, and as a result make decisions and behave in alignment with our objectives and vision. People who achieve this ability can accomplish business and personal relationship goals with ease and unimagined success. RIL teaches people to apply this intelligence to their everyday decisions and behaviors through RIL's Emotional Literacy Learning Process.

What Is Emotional Literacy?

There are many events that we want to leave behind so we cloud them up or we create pleasant illusions to cover up the pain. When we do this we then forget in our conscious minds what happened. When any experience is changed and the feelings are diluted and dulled, the particles don't go away. The particles build up and begin to control our behavior, albeit unconsciously. This can lead to disastrous results

We develop our patterns of side-stepping painful emotions, patterns of interpretation and protection, in our childhood. Because these patterns are developed during our childhood many of us have no idea what and when we're feeling, we are really reacting to a situation according to the patterns we developed as children. We "act out." Acting out is when we feel something like sadness or anger or happiness and either don't realize it, don't understand why, or won't allow ourselves to experience the feelings all the way. Instead they explode or leak out in other ways. For instance, a child who is jealous of a new sibling is not usually allowed to feel that--instead they may stab the baby with crayons, twist the baby's foot through the bars of the crib or burn their own dolls. Similarly, feelings of jealousy on the job may not be experienced, but acted out through backbiting or sabotage.

Emotional literacy is the ability to be self aware. With this self awareness, we can behave in ways that produce specific, desired results in the workplace. Emotional literacy specifically teaches tools for people to become conscious of their own experiences, feelings,

and resistance to change, so that they are not compelled to continue old behavioral patterns that unconsciously sabotage their relationships with managers, employees, customers, friends or family. It includes developing the skills to recognize the unspoken messages from others, so that individuals can align themselves and address real needs and issues. The direct results include the development of authentic, healthy relationships based upon trust and relevant information. These results can translate into motivated, empowered employees and loyal customers.

Real Impact Learning and Business Results

A disadvantage of not feeling everything is that we misinterpret what is going on with other people. This can be deadly in our relationships and damaging to our businesses. Someone we are dealing with may be acting angry, and if we are not able to experience anger we may think they are sad or not notice- and act on that faulty information. The results can range from hurt feelings to a lost contract or a business setback. For example, if we think our relationship with a client is positive, and we are not aware of our own feelings, we will most likely be unaware of our client's real needs. Then we become surprised when they leave. We don't understand why they left. We say things like "I didn't do anything wrong." This kind of misinterpreting seriously damages business and personal relationships.

People tend to base their behavior on how they do or don't feel, not what they want to achieve. Communication theory research states that all decisions have an emotional component. Many organizations appear to be making decisions from a rational perspective, but when in fact examined more closely the decisions are based in avoiding pain and fear. When decisions are made from avoiding pain and fear, situations are created that result in things like:

- Missing a client's real needs and therefore the full potential of a sale
- Losing creative/trained people to other organizations
- Losing clients due to lack of trust and confidence
- Wasted time and duplicated effort

Knowing the emotional underpinning of the decisions that we make and the emotional content of interactions with our co-workers and clients can provide a new dimension of comprehension to almost every situation in the workplace. Orloff Consulting has spent over 20 years teaching the technology of emotional literacy and its applications at work.

1. Emotional Literacy includes developing the skills to recognize the unspoken messages from others, so that individuals can align themselves and address real needs and issues.
2. *For example, a client's words may be about the cost being too much, but the real issue may be a lack of trust. Or, an associate may be acting angry but underneath, they are really just having a hard time with change.*
3. An Emotionally Literate person doesn't read something into an

interaction or situation. An Emotionally Literate person knows what is truly going on. He or she won't respond to something happening now with a response from their history.

4. *For example, if a manager behaves in a way that seems to be similar to a disrespectful manager from the past, they just notice that as information—but don't act on whatever feelings that resemblance engenders.*
5. Emotional Literacy teaches people to become conscious of their own experiences, feelings, and resistance to change, so that they can change old behavioral patterns rather than be compelled to continue them. *If a firm is undergoing significant change, an emotionally literate person understands that cognitive dissonance (explanation) is part of the process of adapting to change and growing.. Knowing this, a person is able to choose short-term discomfort for long-term behavioral change.*

An emotionally literate person is able to create Trusted Advisor relationships by listening to clients' deepest needs and desires and responds in an authentic manner.

Applying Emotional Literacy in the workplace translates into creating and retaining loyal customers, motivated, empowered employees and a significant increase in sales.

Orloff Consulting developed the Emotional Literacy Technology by observing, studying, and mapping the underlying nature of people and their desire to experience connection and eliminate separation.

By applying this technology to our own organization and our clients, we have gained an understanding of how the brain works in relationship to emotions and behavior. This understanding led to the knowledge that people need not be controlled by emotional impulses, either conscience or unconscious, and that it is possible to make real choices about behaviors when there is a conscious awareness of emotions. We have demonstrated to some of the country's largest companies that when the principles of emotional literacy are applied, they are like gravity—they work whether we believe in it or not.

Historically, there have been numerous individuals who have intuitively acted in ways that promoted the nurturing of these principles. A few have explored the theory of how and why certain “ways of being” produce the experiences all humans seek. The concept of emotional intelligence is gaining acceptance in the marketplace through the work of people like Peter Senge and Daniel Goleman.

In the adult learning field, OC is the only company to identify a methodology and develop a specific learning system to transfer a skill set that can be used to effectively master emotional literacy in the workplace.